9.8.9 Joby Aviation – FAA certification and commercial deployment pathway in the United States

Joby Aviation, a California-based aerospace company, is one of the leading developers of electric vertical take-off and landing (eVTOL) aircraft intended for commercial passenger service in the United States. Joby's eVTOL is designed to operate as a quiet, zero-operational-emissions air taxi, capable of transporting passengers across urban regions, bypassing traffic congestion and reducing travel times. With a targeted range of approximately 150+ km and cruising speeds around 300 km/h, Joby's aircraft is optimized for short to medium intra-city and regional travel.

What distinguishes Joby's progress is its structured and phased approach to FAA (Federal Aviation Administration) certification, which is essential for legal commercial flight operations in the United States. The company is pursuing Type Certification (aircraft meets regulatory airworthiness standards), Production Certification (manufacturing quality compliance), and Part 135 Air Carrier Certification (authorization to operate air taxi services). Joby has already obtained Part 135 certification, allowing it to begin operational training and early pilot service development. Flight testing continues under FAA oversight, including performance validation, safety redundancy demonstration, and noise certification trials.

To support deployment, Joby has partnered with Delta Air Lines to integrate drone air taxi services into airport ground-to-terminal mobility in major US metropolitan regions. This partnership focuses on reducing travel delays during airport transfers – one of the most promising early-phase commercial business models for UAM. Joby is also developing vertiport infrastructure, autonomous traffic management interfaces, and digital passenger booking systems designed to function seamlessly with existing city transport networks.